

Firearms Trace Data: West Virginia - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in West Virginia in Calendar Year 2023

2,130

Firearm Types with a West Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	1,226
Rifles	381
Revolvers	217
Shotguns	189
Machineguns	57
Receivers/Frames	18
Derringers	16
Machinegun Conversion Devices	12
Other*	14

* Other includes Unknown Types, Combinations and a Silencer.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a West Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	696
.22 Cal	300
.380 Cal	136

12GA	123
.45 Cal	112
.40 Cal	103
.38 Cal	79
5.56mm	46
7.62mm	39
.25 Cal	35
.357 Cal	35
.223 Cal	33
20GA	33

NOTE: There were 212 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 148 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a West Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	656
Possession of Weapon	473
Dangerous Drugs	455
Found Firearm	134
Weapon Offense	66
Property Crimes	61
Family Offense	53
Homicide	40

Aggravated Assault	30
Firing Weapon	21
Homicide - Attempted	18

NOTE: There were 123 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a West Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

West Virginia	1,171
Ohio	111
Virginia	64
Kentucky	56
Pennsylvania	51
Georgia	20
Maryland	20
North Carolina	18
Florida	17
Tennessee	11
Michigan	10
Texas	10
Alabama	9
Indiana	9
Louisiana	7

South Carolina	7
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NOTE: An additional 19 states accounted for 49 other traces. The source state was identified in 1,640 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a West Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	99
3 Months to Under 7 Months	82
7 Months to Under 1 Year	102
1 Year to Under 2 Years	178
2 Years to Under 3 Years	186
3 Years and Over	990

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 West Virginia Average Time-to-Crime: **9.11 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a West Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	17
18 to 21	82
22 to 24	131
25 to 30	208

31 to 40	445
41 to 50	376
Over 50	289

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 West Virginia Average Age of Possessor: **39 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a West Virginia Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Charleston	332
Huntington	274
Beckley	118
Clarksburg	78
Parkersburg	78
Morgantown	68
Martinsburg	65
Saint Albans	58
Nitro	54
South Charleston	43

NOTE: There were 169 additional municipalities that accounted for 781 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 181 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of West Virginia. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to West Virginia.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a West Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a West Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a West Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a West Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a West Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.

- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a West Virginia Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024